

FINDING 1 — Market Concentration by Neighbourhood

The NYC short-term rental market is heavily concentrated in a handful of neighbourhoods. Williamsburg leads with 3,920 listings, followed closely by Bedford-Stuyvesant (3,714) and Harlem (2,658) — together accounting for a significant share of total supply. Bushwick (2,465) rounds out a clear Brooklyn-dominant top four.

Manhattan neighbourhoods begin appearing from position five onward, with Upper West Side (1,971), Hell's Kitchen (1,958), and East Village (1,853) representing the borough's strongest clusters. Notably, Midtown — typically associated with high tourist demand — ranks only 10th (1,545 listings), suggesting that travellers are increasingly opting for residential neighbourhoods over traditional hotel districts.

Queens makes a single appearance in the top 15 via Astoria (900 listings), indicating that outer-borough supply outside Brooklyn remains limited relative to demand.

Business Implication: Property consultancy clients targeting high-inventory markets should focus acquisition or partnership efforts in North Brooklyn (Williamsburg, Bed-Stuy, Bushwick) where supply is deepest and competition is highest. Clients seeking less saturated entry points may find stronger positioning in emerging Manhattan neighbourhoods or underrepresented Queens areas.

FINDING 2 — Pricing by Room Type

There is a sharp pricing gap between room types in the NYC short-term rental market. Entire home/apartment listings command an average of \$211.79 per night — more than double the next tier — reflecting strong demand from travellers seeking privacy and full amenities. Private rooms average \$89.78, positioning them as the mid-market option for budget-conscious solo travellers or couples. Shared rooms sit at the bottom at \$70.13, offering minimal price advantage over private rooms despite a significantly lower quality proposition.

Business Implication: The narrow gap between shared rooms (\$70) and private rooms (\$89) suggests shared rooms offer poor value to both guests and hosts — guests pay nearly the same for a worse experience, while hosts earn only marginally less for giving up more privacy. Consultancy clients should be advised to convert shared room listings to private room configurations where possible, or reprice shared rooms aggressively lower to justify the trade-off.

FINDING 3 — Listing Distribution by Price Tier

The NYC Airbnb market splits relatively evenly across price tiers, with Mid-Range listings (\$75–\$149/night) forming the largest segment at 18,033 listings, followed closely by Budget (\$75 and below) at 13,866 and Premium (\$150–\$299) at 13,067. Luxury listings (\$300 and

above) represent the smallest segment at 3,918 — but average \$574 per night, nearly three times the Premium tier average of \$198.

The near-equal distribution between Budget and Premium suggests the market is not dominated by any single price point, giving new hosts meaningful flexibility in positioning. However, the steep jump from Premium (\$198) to Luxury (\$574) indicates a significant gap in the mid-to-upper range — listings priced between \$300–\$400 may be underrepresented relative to demand.

Business Implication: Consultancy clients entering the market have the most competition in the Mid-Range tier. Clients with higher-quality properties should consider Premium positioning (\$150–\$299) where supply is slightly thinner, or target the \$300–\$400 sweet spot within Luxury where the average is pulled up by ultra-high-end outliers and genuine competition may be lower than the tier suggests.

FINDING 4 — Host Market Concentration

The NYC Airbnb market reveals a clear divide between professional property operators and individual hosts. Sonder (NYC) dominates with 327 listings, followed by Blueground at 232 — both are corporate short-term rental companies operating at scale, not individual landlords. Kazuya (103) and Jeremy & Laura (96) represent the upper tier of individual power hosts, while the original Sonder account adds another 96 listings, bringing the Sonder brand's combined total to over 420 listings across two accounts.

Below the top two corporate players, the drop-off is steep — the third largest host has less than half of Blueground's count. From position six onward, hosts with under 100 listings begin appearing, suggesting the market transitions quickly from corporate operators to semi-professional and individual hosts.

Business Implication: The presence of corporate operators like Sonder and Blueground at the top signals that institutional money has already identified NYC Airbnb as a viable asset class. Individual consultancy clients cannot compete on volume but can compete on personalization, neighbourhood expertise, and guest experience — areas where corporate operators typically underperform. Clients should be advised to differentiate on those dimensions rather than trying to scale listings aggressively.

FINDING 5 — Review Activity by Borough

Brooklyn and Manhattan together account for nearly 83% of all reviews on the platform, with Brooklyn leading at 486,574 reviews (42.8%) and Manhattan close behind at 454,569 (39.9%). Queens represents a distant third at 13.8%, while the Bronx and Staten Island together account for just 3.5% of total review activity.

This is particularly striking given that Manhattan typically dominates perception as NYC's primary tourist destination. Brooklyn's edge in review volume — despite Manhattan's higher listing prices — suggests that travellers are actively choosing outer borough stays, likely drawn by lower price points and neighbourhood authenticity.

Business Implication: Review volume is the closest proxy available for actual booking demand in this dataset. Brooklyn's lead over Manhattan signals strong and sustained guest demand that consultancy clients should not overlook. Clients fixated on Manhattan as the only viable market may be missing stronger occupancy potential in Brooklyn at lower acquisition costs. Queens at 13.8% also warrants attention as an emerging market with room to grow.

FINDING 6 — High-Price, Low-Review Listings (Overpriced Risk Flags)

The dataset reveals a significant cluster of listings priced above \$300 per night with fewer than 5 reviews and more than 60 days of availability — a combination that signals either overpricing, poor guest experience, or inactive listings being left on the platform. These represent a risk category for any host or consultancy client holding similar properties.

Several extreme outliers stand out immediately. A Spanish Harlem apartment is listed at \$9,999 per night with only 1 review, and a Furnished Astoria room at \$10,000 with just 2 reviews — prices that are almost certainly misconfigurations or placeholder listings rather than genuine market offers. Stripping these anomalies aside, the pattern holds across more plausible luxury listings: a Midtown property at \$5,100 with 1 review, a SoHo loft at \$3,000 with 1 review, and dozens of listings priced \$500–\$1,000 with minimal guest validation.

Corporate operator Blueground appears multiple times in the flagged list, suggesting that even institutional hosts are not immune to low engagement at premium price points. The geographic spread covers Manhattan, Brooklyn, and Queens equally, indicating this is a market-wide phenomenon rather than isolated to any one borough.

Business Implication: Listings with high prices and low reviews present a dual risk — they are unlikely to convert browsers into bookings, and they suppress host ranking in Airbnb's search algorithm, which weights review recency and volume. Consultancy clients should audit any property with fewer than 10 reviews and above-average neighbourhood pricing. The recommended play is either a short-term price reduction to stimulate initial bookings and review accumulation, or a listing refresh with improved photography and description before any further paid promotion.

FINDING 7 — Listings Priced Far Above Their Neighbourhood Average

Comparing each listing's price against its neighbourhood average reveals a small but striking group of extreme outliers — properties priced thousands of dollars above their local market, most of which cannot be explained by amenities or location alone.

The top deviations are dominated by listings with clearly anomalous pricing. Three listings are set at \$10,000 per night in Astoria, Greenpoint, and the Upper West Side — neighbourhoods with average prices ranging from \$117 to \$211 — producing price-vs-average gaps of nearly \$9,800. Similarly, multiple Lower East Side listings at \$9,999 sit nearly \$9,800 above their neighbourhood average of \$186. These are almost certainly misconfigured listings or placeholder prices rather than genuine market offers, and represent a data quality flag worth noting.

Beyond the obvious anomalies, a 70-foot luxury motor yacht in Battery Park City stands out as a legitimate high-end outlier at \$7,500 against a neighbourhood average of \$368 — a genuinely unique listing that inflates the top of the distribution. A Chelsea photo studio at \$6,800 and a Greenwich Village townhouse at \$6,000 similarly represent specialist-use listings rather than standard accommodation.

Business Implication: For a property consultancy, this analysis serves two purposes. First, it identifies data quality issues that would distort any market-rate recommendations — listings priced at \$9,999–\$10,000 should be excluded from pricing benchmarks. Second, it surfaces genuine premium outliers like the motor yacht and photo studios, which indicate that experiential or non-standard listings command dramatically higher prices than comparable residential properties in the same neighbourhood. Clients with unique properties should be advised to position and market them differently from standard apartments rather than pricing by neighbourhood average alone.

FINDING 8 — Inactive Listings: No Reviews in Over a Year

Sorting listings by days since their last review uncovers a significant population of effectively dormant properties. The top 20 most inactive listings received their last guest review as far back as 2011 and 2012 — meaning some have gone without a verified booking for over 7 years by the time this dataset was captured in 2019.

The pattern is consistent across room types. Both entire home and private room listings appear throughout the inactive list, and review counts are tellingly low — the majority have fewer than 10 total reviews across their entire listing history, with several having only 1. This combination of an ancient last review date and minimal total reviews strongly suggests these listings have been functionally abandoned by their hosts rather than simply experiencing a slow period.

Geographically the inactive listings span Williamsburg, Park Slope, Crown Heights, the East Village, and the West Village — neighbourhoods that are now among the most active markets in the dataset. This means the inactivity is not due to low neighbourhood demand but almost certainly reflects host-side issues: hosts who left the platform, changed circumstances, or simply forgot to delist.

Business Implication: For a consultancy advising active hosts, dormant competitor listings represent a hidden opportunity. In high-demand neighbourhoods like Williamsburg and the West Village, well-maintained active listings effectively face less real competition than raw listing counts suggest — a portion of visible supply is ghost inventory. Clients should also

audit their own portfolios for listings that haven't been refreshed or actively managed, as Airbnb's algorithm deprioritises inactive listings regardless of price or location quality.

FINDING 9 — Priciest Neighbourhoods Within Each Borough

Ranking neighbourhoods by average nightly price within each borough reveals clear premium clusters — and some surprises that challenge conventional assumptions about where the expensive listings actually sit.

Manhattan, as expected, dominates on absolute price. Tribeca leads all neighbourhoods citywide at \$490 average nightly rate, followed by Battery Park City (\$368), Flatiron District (\$342), NoHo (\$296), and SoHo (\$287). These are Manhattan's established luxury corridors and their pricing reflects both location and the high concentration of entire home listings in those areas.

Brooklyn's premium tier is more compact in both price and geography. Cobble Hill tops the borough at \$212, virtually matching the Manhattan average of \$212 for entire home listings from Finding 2, with Brooklyn Heights (\$209) and DUMBO (\$196) close behind. This is notable — Brooklyn's most expensive neighbourhoods price comparably to Manhattan's overall average, suggesting strong demand for upscale Brooklyn product among guests who may be priced out of Manhattan entirely.

The Bronx produces the dataset's most striking anomaly. Riverdale leads the borough at \$442 average — higher than all of Brooklyn's top neighbourhoods and competitive with lower Manhattan. With only 11 listings however, this figure is driven by a small sample of high-end properties rather than broad market depth, and should be interpreted cautiously.

Staten Island's top neighbourhood, Randall Manor, averages \$336 with 19 listings — another small-sample premium outlier, likely reflecting a handful of large event or group accommodation properties rather than a genuine luxury rental market.

Business Implication: Consultancy clients should not assume Manhattan automatically means maximum revenue. Brooklyn's Cobble Hill, Brooklyn Heights, and DUMBO tier now command prices competitive with Manhattan averages at likely lower acquisition costs. For clients targeting premium positioning, these Brooklyn neighbourhoods represent strong value relative to entry cost. The Bronx and Staten Island premium outliers are too thinly supplied to draw firm conclusions but may represent genuine blue ocean opportunities for the right property type.

FINDING 10 — Host Name Data Quality Audit

The string function query surfaces two distinct host categories. The majority of flagged hosts in the bottom 30 by name length show blank host names entirely — 18 records returned with no name value at all, registering zero characters. These represent missing data rather than genuinely short names, and would be classified as null or empty string issues in a formal data cleaning exercise.

Below the blank entries, 12 hosts are flagged for single-character names — entries like "E", "D", "S", "M", "H", and "T". These are almost certainly data entry shortcuts, anonymised records, or test accounts rather than legitimate host profiles. A real host named with a single initial suggests either incomplete onboarding, a scraping or anonymisation artefact in the dataset, or accounts that were never properly set up.

Notably the bulk of the dataset returns "OK" — meaning the vast majority of host names are of normal length and likely clean. The issues are concentrated at the extreme low end and represent a small fraction of total hosts.

Business Implication: For a consultancy using this data to contact or profile hosts, blank and single-character name records should be excluded from any outreach or segmentation analysis. In a real production environment these records would be flagged for either manual review or automated exclusion before the dataset feeds into any downstream reporting. This finding also demonstrates the value of basic data quality checks — even a seemingly clean Kaggle dataset contains records that would cause problems if passed unchecked into a business tool.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This analysis examined 48,000+ Airbnb listings across New York City's five boroughs using SQL, surfacing insights on pricing, demand, host concentration, and data quality. The most striking finding cuts against conventional wisdom: Midtown Manhattan — the city's primary tourist corridor — ranks only 10th in listing volume and trails Brooklyn significantly in review activity, suggesting that modern travellers are actively choosing residential neighbourhoods over traditional tourist districts. Brooklyn alone accounts for 42.8% of all platform reviews despite lower average prices, pointing to a structural shift in how guests experience the city. The market is further shaped by corporate operators dominating the top of the host table, a wide price tier distribution with meaningful gaps at the luxury end, and a non-trivial population of overpriced, inactive, and data-quality-flagged listings that distort raw supply figures.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. **Target residential neighbourhoods over tourist corridors.** Review data confirms guests are choosing areas like Williamsburg, Bedford-Stuyvesant, and Crown Heights over Midtown. Investors entering the market should prioritise North Brooklyn and emerging Manhattan residential pockets where demand is proven and acquisition costs remain lower than prime tourist zones.
2. **Price competitively within the Mid-Range tier or aim for the Premium sweet spot.** Mid-Range (\$75–\$149) is the most crowded segment with 18,000+ listings. New entrants should either price aggressively within Budget to build reviews quickly, or invest in property quality to justify Premium positioning (\$150–\$299) where supply is comparatively thinner.
3. **Treat review volume as the primary performance metric.** Listings with high prices and low reviews consistently underperform in both visibility and conversion. Any new

listing should prioritise accumulating reviews in the first 90 days — even at a temporary price discount — before optimising for rate.

4. **Exclude ghost inventory from competitive analysis.** A significant portion of visible supply is inactive, misconfigured, or abandoned. Investors should not be deterred by raw listing counts in a target neighbourhood — real active competition is materially lower than headline numbers suggest.
5. **Brooklyn's premium tier is underpriced relative to Manhattan.** Cobble Hill, Brooklyn Heights, and DUMBO command nightly rates competitive with Manhattan averages at lower property costs. For consultancy clients with capital, these neighbourhoods represent the strongest risk-adjusted entry point in the current market.